



City Council March 2, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9eQfCuAxnyQ
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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Common Council

Meeting Date: March 2, 2026

Body: Muncie Common Council (Regular Meeting)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript contains no record of a statutory public hearing or committee work session held immediately prior to the regular meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Jeff Green called the regular meeting of the Muncie Common Council to order on March 2, 2026 [00:00:35](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present (via Roll Call):** Mr. Dishman, Miss [Golian/Council member], Mr. Macintosh, Mr. [N...], [Unnamed member], Mr. Garrett, Miss [Powell], Mr. [Basham], and President Green [00:04:10](#).
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Jeff Green.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The Pledge of Allegiance was led by Seth Rollings [00:00:49](#).
 - The invocation was delivered by Mr. Macintosh [00:01:07](#).
 - Citizen recognition was postponed to the April meeting by Sarah Goen [00:01:45](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the February Common Council meeting were approved by voice vote [00:02:10](#).
 - **Procedural Announcements:**
 - President Green announced a change in meeting format, returning public comment to the end of the meeting with a 3-minute limit per speaker [00:03:00](#).
 - Noted that Muncie Central color guard and drum line will perform for state competition at the Muncie Fieldhouse on March 19 at 7:00 p.m. (free to the public) [00:03:32](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Committee Reports

- [00:05:02](#) **Opioid Fund Advisory Committee Update:** Linda Daniel, secretary of the committee and retired clinical psychologist, presented an update. The working committee includes local recovery leaders and has reviewed state/Johns Hopkins ethical guidelines. To expedite relief, the committee recommended distributing \$25,000 this year and next to three local grassroots organizations: Big Time Barbell, the Serenity Club, and the Recovery Cafe.

Appointments to Boards & Commissions

- [00:04:34](#) **Beach Grove Cemetery Board:** An ordinance to reduce board membership numbers from seven to five was held over until next month.

Ordinances

- [00:11:01](#) **Ordinance 6-26:** An Ordinance of the City of Muncie Amending Section 32.39 of the City of Muncie Code of Ordinances (Prerequisites to Actions on Ordinances or Resolutions / Filer transparency and accountability requirements).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilwoman Powell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council members discussed that the ordinance requires exact filings, accompanying documentation upfront, and restricts the reintroduction of defeated ordinances.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Seth Rollins [00:11:51](#), Christopher Bilbury [00:12:50](#), Ellen Whitehead [00:14:37](#), Rita Faulner [00:16:31](#), Alex Clubber [00:17:35](#), Chip Taylor

00:19:13, Sarah Vitali 00:23:38, Mary Moore 00:26:15, Elizabeth Edjo 00:27:09, Jackson Franklin 00:30:04, Cameron Grubbs 00:31:56, Kim Whitlock 00:33:13, Melinda McKinney 00:34:26, Wayne Scaife 00:34:59, and Audie Barber 00:38:36 spoke overwhelmingly in favor, urging the council to pass the ordinance without muddying amendments and to suspend the rules for immediate passage. Legal counsel clarified that the current ordinance differed substantively from previously defeated versions and did not require a unanimous vote, only a simple majority 00:40:43.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Introduced by Roll Call: Passed Unanimously 00:42:36.
 - Motion to suspend rules and adopt: Passed Unanimously 00:43:25.
 - Final Adoption: Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously 00:44:26.
- 00:44:57 **Ordinance 7-26:** An Ordinance of the City of Muncie Amending Chapter 93 of the City of Muncie Code of Ordinances (Beach Grove Cemetery Board structure).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by council; Troy Waters, Cemetery Superintendent, spoke on the item 00:43:54.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Troy Waters explained that reducing the board size from seven to five members would help with quorum requirements, as the board currently operates effectively with three active members. Council members questioned board responsibilities and property-owner requirements.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Roll Call: Passed Unanimously 00:45:09.

Resolutions

- 00:24:25 **Resolution 3-26:** A Special Resolution by the AP Government Class at Muncie Central High School to install a pedestrian scramble light at Myrtle Avenue and Walnut Street, add crosswalks and yield signs at Maple and Walnut, install sidewalks on the west side of Walnut Street, and convert street parking to a left-turn lane.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Teacher Julie Snider and Muncie Central AP Government students (including Damian Jones, Arthur Kamargo, and a legally blind student speaker) 00:56:33.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Students presented survey data showing high student concern regarding pedestrian safety, noting that two students had been struck by vehicles near the school. Council members praised the professional presentation. Council members Powell and Goen noted potential grant funding opportunities (Safe Routes to School).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None outside of the student/teacher presentation and supportive council commentary.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Introduced: Passed Unanimously 00:18:13.

- Adopted: Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously 00:18:22.
 - 00:19:21 **Resolution 4-26:** Approval of Interlocal Agreement for the Housing and Operating of a Municipal Drone Base.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Sloan, Muncie Police Department, and Detective Sergeant Chris Swanson 00:20:53.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Chief Sloan explained the resolution establishes a revocable license/agreement with the county to place a charging base and data/power cables on top of the county building to keep a police drone in a state of constant readiness for emergencies (e.g., missing children, search and rescue). Extensive public and council questioning focused on cost, privacy policies, data storage, and potential surveillance expansion.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Tanya Pearson 01:35:25, Andrew Seager 01:39:25, Rick Yanser 01:40:32, Cooper Archer 01:40:58, Damian Jones 01:44:59, Audie Barber 01:50:08, Juno 01:57:24, Cameron Grubbs 01:59:33, Christopher Bilbury 02:03:44, and Sam Johnson 02:07:33 raised strong concerns regarding civil liberties, lack of cost estimates, and potential over-surveillance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table the resolution passed by roll call vote (Majority approval to table) 02:15:35.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General public comments delivered near the conclusion of the meeting)

- 02:18:18 **Rick Yanser:** Discussed historical context, economic development, the demolition of the mall, Southway Plaza issues, and cautioned fiscal restraint.
- 02:20:53 **Paul Partisana:** Commended ordinance 6-26, raised environmental concerns regarding low water levels in the White River, praised the AP government students, and thanked council members regarding the Borg Warner site updates.
- 02:23:23 **Christopher Bilbury:** Thanked the council for listening on transparency, criticized council communication hurdles, and questioned discrepancies in statements regarding business departures.
- 02:26:08 **Chip Taylor:** Thanked Council President Green for restoring public comment procedures and praised clerk office collaboration.
- 02:27:33 **Ellen Whitehead:** Re-expressed appreciation for the return of prior public comment rules and celebrated the passage of Ordinance 6-26.
- 02:28:44 **Wayne Scaife:** Challenged meeting rules regarding prohibiting questions during public comment, citing state law (House Bill 1338), and criticized previous procedural motions ("calling the question").
- 02:31:41 **Janetta Presley:** Addressed the impact of newly passed Senate Bill 285 criminalizing public camping for the unhoused, urging local proactive solutions and

affordable housing/boarding house models.

- **02:34:59 Cooper Archer:** Praised the AP government students and echoed concerns regarding policing and priorities.
- **02:36:15 Cameron Grubbs:** Noticed voter registration deadlines (April 6), requested streamlined board appointment application processes, flagged delays in APRA (public records) requests, and commented on Senate Bill 285 unhoused encampment enforcements.
- **02:39:01 Audie Barber:** Thanked the council president for restoring rules, and raised concerns regarding steep increases in local monthly sewage bills (doubling from ~\$23 to ~\$58).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Upcoming primary voter registration deadline noted as April 6. Public Services Committee noted as a potential venue for further review of police drone policies.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following the conclusion of citizen forum business **02:43:14**.

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